

GABRIEL ROJAS BOWE

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EDUCATION

University of California, Los Angeles Ph.D. Candidate in Neuroscience (advanced to candidacy December 2024)	<i>2021 – Present</i> GPA: 3.88
University of Puerto Rico, Río Piedras Bachelor of Science in Cell and Molecular Biology (Dean’s List)	<i>2016 – 2021</i> GPA: 3.67

RESEARCH TRAINING

2022 – Present	Doctoral Researcher, UCLA, Advisor: Anne Churchland, Ph.D.
2018 – 2021	Undergraduate Researcher, UPR Río Piedras, Advisor: Gregory Quirk, Ph.D.
2020	Summer Researcher, UCLA, Advisor: Gina Poe, Ph.D.
2018	Summer Researcher, University of Chicago, Advisor: Robert Carrillo, Ph.D.

GRANTS AND FELLOWSHIPS

2023 – 2026	National Science Foundation (NSF) Graduate Research Fellowship
2021 – 2024	UCLA Eugene V. Cota-Robles Fellowship
2021	UCLA Competitive EDGE Fellowship
2019 – 2021	NIH Minority Access to Research Careers (MARC) Fellowship
2018 – 2019	NIH Research Initiative for Scientific Enhancement (RISE) Fellowship

AWARDS, HONORS, AND RECOGNITIONS

2022	Achievement Rewards for College Scientists (ARCS) Foundation Los Angeles Founder Chapter Scholar Award
2021	UCLA Graduate Dean’s Scholar Award
2021	3rd Best Poster Presentation, UCLA BRI Undergraduate Research Poster Fair
2020	SACNAS Registration Scholarship Award
2019	Princeton Ph.D. Preview (P3) Program Scholar, Travel Award
2018	ABRCMS Outstanding Poster Presentation Award

PUBLICATIONS

Peer Reviewed

- Yin, C., Melin, M.D., **Rojas-Bowe, G.**, Sun, X.R., Couto, J., Gluf, S., Kostiuk, A., Musall, S., Churchland, A.K. “Spontaneous movements and their relationship to neural activity fluctuate with latent engagement states.” *Neuron* 113, 3048–3063.e5 (2025). doi: 10.1016/j.neuron.2025.06.001
- Diehl, M.M., Iravedra-García, J.M., Morán-Sierra, J., **Rojas-Bowe, G.**, González-Díaz, F.N., Valentín-Valentín, V., Quirk, G.J. “Divergent projections of the prelimbic cortex bidirectionally regulate active avoidance.” *eLife* (2020). doi: 10.7554/eLife.59281

SELECTED CONFERENCE POSTERS

2021	Society for Neuroscience. Prelimbic neurons signal approach-avoidance conflict. Rojas-Bowe, G. et al.
2020	SACNAS. Prefrontal neuronal signaling of approach-avoidance conflict. Rojas-Bowe, G. et al.
2020	UCLA BRI Undergraduate Summer Research Poster Fair. The effects of REM sleep deprivation in the extinction of traumatic memories. Rojas-Bowe, G. et al.
2019	ABRCMS. Prelimbic cortex exerts bidirectional control of active avoidance through inputs to ventral striatum and basolateral amygdala. Rojas-Bowe, G. et al.
2018	ABRCMS. Identifying interactors of the Dpr-DIP pathway. Rojas-Bowe, G. et al. Outstanding Poster Presentation Award.

RESEARCH TALKS

2026	Research in Progress Seminar (RiPS), UCLA Brain Research Institute. <i>Sensory encoding during decision-making.</i>
2026	BRI-SURE Summer Program. <i>Freely moving visual encoding during decision making.</i>
2025	Research in Progress Seminar (RiPS), UCLA Brain Research Institute. <i>Investigating the impact of movements on visual processing during freely-moving behavior.</i>
2025	Behavioral Neuroscience Journal Club, UCLA Department of Psychology. <i>Investigating the impact of movements on visual processing during freely-moving behavior.</i>

JOURNAL CLUB PRESENTATIONS

2025	Integrative Center for Learning and Memory (ICLM) Journal Club. <i>A thalamic hub-and-spoke network enables visual perception during action by coordinating visuomotor dynamics.</i>
2024	ICLM Journal Club. <i>Survey of spiking in the mouse visual system reveals functional hierarchy.</i>
2023	ICLM Journal Club. <i>Thalamus-driven functional populations in frontal cortex support decision-making.</i>

LEADERSHIP POSITIONS

2026 – Present	Churchland Lab AI lead: led lab discussions on research uses of AI and drafted the lab's first AI-use policy
2026	Co-leader: Electrophysiology day, UCLA Neuroscience Interdepartmental Graduate Program Bootcamp
2023 – Present	Graduate Student Representative, UCLA Brain Research Institute Steering Committee
2022 – 2024	Program Director, UCLA Brain Awareness Week
2021	Cohort Representative, UCLA Competitive EDGE Summer Program
2019 – 2021	Executive Committee and Founding Member, Neuroboricuas UPR Río Piedras

PROFESSIONAL SOCIETIES

2019 – Present	Society for Neuroscience
2019 – Present	Society for the Advancement of Chicanos/Hispanics and Native Americans in Science (SACNAS)

OUTREACH

2026	Participant: UCLA Neuroscience Undergraduate Society networking Q&A
2026	Judge: BRI-SURE Poster Fair
2025	Panelist: UCLA Graduate Programs in Bioscience (GPB) new-student orientation
2024	Panelist: ARCS Foundation Los Angeles Scholar Panel
2024	Panelist: Los Angeles Brain Bee professional panel
2023 – Present	Knowing Neurons Spanish Translation Project (bilingual lesson plans, classroom materials, and Los Angeles school visits)
2023	Speaker: NSIDP Orientation, Brain Awareness Week presentation
2023	Panelist: UCLA Graduate Programs in Bioscience (GPB) panel
2023	Panelist: UCLA Grad Ambassadors graduate admissions panels
2022	Panelist: GradSTRIVE, former mentee–returning mentors
2022	Speaker: BRI-SURE Summer Program
2022	Moderator: National McNair Conference
2022 – 2023	Mentor: Project Short
2022	Pen Pal STEM Professional: Letters to a Pre-Scientist
2022	Judge: California Science and Engineering Fair
2021	Speaker: Escuela Secundaria de la Universidad de Puerto Rico STEM Symposium
2020 – 2021	Student Adviser: Cientifico Latino

RESEARCH MENTORING

2026 – Present	Ph.D. rotation mentor, Churchland Lab: Dua Azhar (starts Fall 2026)
2022 – Present	Undergraduate mentor, Churchland Lab: Kevin Bae, Lillian Means, and Zola Mininger-Clark

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

2026 – Present	Freelance tutor: Honors Chemistry, Genetics, Spanish, AP Spanish, AP Biology, Neuroanatomy, Neurophysiology, MATLAB, Essay Writing, and Machine Learning/AI
2023	Instructor: Encoding models workshop (with Dr. Maxwell Melin), Caltech
2023	Teaching Assistant: NEU 210B, Methods in Neuroscience (graduate course), UCLA
2018	Teaching Assistant: Organic Chemistry 1
2017	Teaching Assistant: General Biology 2
2015	Fourth-grade tutor: Local after-school center